

ACN: 2372461

Time / Day

Date : 202606

Local Time Of Day : 0601-1200

Place

Locale Reference.ATC Facility : PHL. TRACON

State Reference : PA

Aircraft

Reference : X

ATC / Advisory. TRACON : PHL

Make Model Name : Any Unknown or Unlisted Aircraft Manufacturer

Person

Location Of Person. Facility : PHL. TRACON

Reporter Organization : Government

Function. Air Traffic Control : Approach

Qualification. Air Traffic Control : Fully Certified

Experience. Air Traffic Control. Time Certified In Pos 1 (yrs) : 19

ASRS Report Number. Accession Number : 2372461

Events

Anomaly. ATC Issue : All Types

Anomaly. Deviation / Discrepancy - Procedural : Published Material / Policy

Anomaly. Ground Event / Encounter : Ground Equipment Issue

Detector. Person : Air Traffic Control

When Detected : In-flight

Result. Air Traffic Control : Separated Traffic

Assessments

Contributing Factors / Situations : ATC Equipment / Nav Facility / Buildings

Primary Problem : ATC Equipment / Nav Facility / Buildings

Narrative: 1

I was scheduled for the XA:00 to XI:00 shift but was held over for an additional two hours to assist with heavy traffic recovery. At approximately XJ:00, my scope displayed an error message indicating a system failure. Moments later, all radar scopes went blank. I immediately contacted the aircraft on my frequency, advised them of the radar failure, and verified their positions. I switched the radar to ES (Emergency Service) mode, which began restoring targets. Radar and communication failures have happened in Area C multiple times in the last 2 years.

Synopsis

PHL TRACON Controller reported the radar scope system failure with the radar scopes going blank resulted in an unsafe air traffic control environment.